

That Magnetic DOG

Magnets attract metal objects like keys and spoons.

My dog Skitty doesn't attract metal. She attracts food.

When Mum has a biscuit with her tea, Skitty gives her that look ... that magnetic look. Before you know it Skitty has a biscuit too. Sometimes more than one. That magnetic look can be very strong.

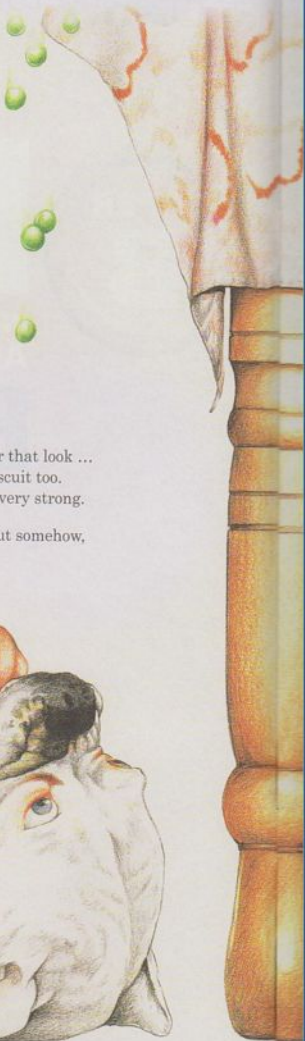
We're not allowed to feed Skitty at the dinner table. But somehow, food always goes in her direction.

When Dad and I make a cake we don't worry about any batter that spills on the floor. We know it will disappear.

And we never ask, 'Who wants the last bit?' Skitty always gets the last bit. Sometimes, she even gets the first bit!

Not that Skitty steals food. She doesn't have to. It just seems to follow her around.

Skitty has magnetism all right. It isn't only food she attracts, she attracts people too. There's no escaping that magnetic look.



1. What do magnets attract?
- (A) food
 - (B) keys
 - (C) dogs
 - (D) people
2. The words 'more than one' mean that Skitty got more than one
- (A) look.
 - (B) biscuit.
 - (C) cup of tea.
 - (D) piece of cake.
3. What happened when Skitty gave 'that magnetic look'?
- (A) The family gave her food.
 - (B) The children let her choose her food.
 - (C) She could eat as much as she wanted.
 - (D) She was allowed to eat from a metal spoon.
4. When Dad and the narrator made a cake, they did not worry about cleaning up because
- (A) Skitty would eat any batter that spilt.
 - (B) Skitty licked the batter before it spilt on the floor.
 - (C) they were careful to make sure that no batter spilt.
 - (D) they knew that Mum would clean up any batter that spilt.
5. 'It just seems to follow her around.'
- The narrator made this statement to make the reader think that
- (A) he found it surprising that Skitty ate so much.
 - (B) he did not know how Skitty got so much food.
 - (C) he thought Skitty's behaviour was very strange.
 - (D) he was not concerned about Skitty's magnetic look.
6. What does the reader know about Skitty from reading the text?
- (A) Skitty likes to lick people.
 - (B) Skitty's favourite food is cake.
 - (C) Skitty is much loved by the family.
 - (D) Skitty steals food from the dinner table.

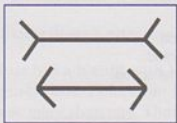
VISUAL ILLUSIONS

The pictures you see here contain visual illusions. Visual illusions fascinate us because we realise our eyes are not really seeing the world exactly as it is.

Seeing is a complex process. We do not just capture images like a photograph or a video; our brains also understand what parts of these images mean. The brain has all kinds of ways of making images simpler so that it can find the important things in an image and get rid of all the unimportant details. However, when the brain simplifies something, it can make mistakes.

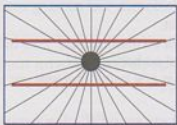
There is still a long way to go before we fully understand how people see. By experimenting with these illusions, we can discover some of the things we do not yet know about vision.

Illusion 1: Which of these lines is longer?



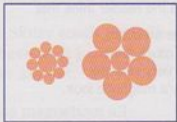
The two lines are the same length. Your eyes follow the direction of the arrows and this makes your brain think that one line is shorter than the other.

Illusion 2: Are the thick lines straight or curved?



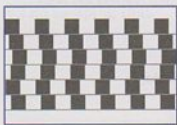
They are straight. The lines radiating from the black spot draw your eyes away from the horizontal lines, making them appear to bend.

Illusion 3: Which centre circle is larger?



They are both the same size. Your brain compares the centre circles with the surrounding ones and decides that one centre circle is smaller than the other.

Illusion 4: Are the bricks in the wall straight?



They are straight. The bricks are rectangles and the lines between them are straight. This interesting visual illusion works when lines between the bricks are brighter than the dark bricks and darker than the light bricks.

7. What does the word 'fascinate' mean?
- (A) trick
 - (B) attract
 - (C) amuse
 - (D) impress
8. Visual illusions can help people to understand
- (A) why the brain works like a camera.
 - (B) how the brain processes information.
 - (C) why the brain likes looking at images.
 - (D) how the brain sees exactly what is presented.
9. Which visual illusion uses dark and light shades to create its effect?
- (A) Illusion 1
 - (B) Illusion 2
 - (C) Illusion 3
 - (D) Illusion 4
10. How can straight lines be made to look curved?
- (A) by making some lines thicker than others
 - (B) by adding arrows at the end of the straight lines
 - (C) by surrounding the straight lines with different sized circles
 - (D) by drawing lines which spread out from a point between the straight lines
11. In the following question which word is the adjective?
- 'Are the bricks in the wall straight?'
- (A) bricks
 - (B) in
 - (C) wall
 - (D) straight
12. What is the purpose of the text next to each illustration?
- (A) to explain how the illusion works
 - (B) to describe how to produce each illusion
 - (C) to describe the visual tricks that are used by artists
 - (D) to explain why the illusion is important for brain research

For questions 13 to 16 choose the correct option to complete the passage.

Maggie

Many people give up some of their free time to help others. They are called volunteers. Maggie goes to a zoo (13) Saturday where she is a volunteer. She has to get up very early and drive to the zoo. During the winter it is still dark and cold when she arrives (14) her destination. Her favourite animals are the pandas (15) were gifts from the Chinese government. She is always delighted (16) she is rostered to help their keeper.

13. (A) one
(B) last
(C) every
(D) either

14. (A) at
(B) in
(C) to
(D) for

15. (A) they
(B) what
(C) those
(D) which

16. (A) when
(B) unless
(C) so that
(D) and then



For questions 17 to 20 read *The fox and the grapes* and choose the best word to complete the passage.

The fox and the grapes

One hot summer's day a fox was strolling through an orchard when he saw a bunch of grapes just ripening on a vine which was growing along a lofty branch. 'Just the thing to _____ (17) _____ my thirst,' he said. Drawing back a few paces, he took a run and a jump and just missed the bunch. Turning around again with a 'One, two, three', he jumped up but with no greater _____ (18) _____. Again and again he tried to reach the _____ (19) _____ fruit. Finally he walked away with his nose in the air, saying, 'I am sure they are sour.'

It is easy to _____ (20) _____ what you cannot get.

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| 17. (A) finish | 18. (A) effort |
| (B) delay | (B) success |
| (C) quench | (C) distance |
| (D) prevent | (D) increase |
| 19. (A) hidden | 20. (A) deny |
| (B) tempting | (B) avoid |
| (C) rewarding | (C) refuse |
| (D) expensive | (D) despise |



BREATHING UNDERWATER

Water was extremely important to Adam Windsong as he grew older because of his ability to breathe in it. This was something he kept secret. That traumatic time when he had been surprised while perfecting his technique in the bath after his dunking in the lake had caused torrents of tears from his mother, an almighty row between her and his father, and the sudden arrival of an ambulance officer who had thumped his chest, pinched his nose, and breathed into his mouth with his own, which smelled of cigarettes and pizza. He remembered all this. Had he not been too young to talk he would have told them all that he was perfectly okay. Just practising. But it was enough to make him realise that underwater breathing was an art that was neither common nor easily understood.

Because of the secrecy involved it was not even an especially useful art. He chose not to make his ability widely known, and had, with just one or two exceptions, resisted the temptation to show off. While a fifth-grade student at Cardigan Bay Primary School he did win the under-11 fifty-metre breaststroke event at the annual swimming carnival by diving in and not resurfacing until he reached the other end, but he was subsequently disqualified when the sports master, Ivan Galbraith, ruled that breaststroke was not an underwater event. This was despite the fact that all the judges had declared Adam's swimming style and kick, at least what they could see of it from the surface, to be impeccable.

21. Why did the ambulance officer thump Adam's chest and pinch his nose?
- (A) He believed that Adam had drowned.
 - (B) He wanted to help Adam to correct his technique.
 - (C) He was punishing Adam for making his mother cry.
 - (D) He was teaching Adam's parents what to do in future.
22. Approximately how old was Adam when he realised he could breathe underwater?
- (A) ten years old
 - (B) five years old
 - (C) older than 11 years old
 - (D) younger than two years old
23. Why did Adam keep his ability to breathe underwater a secret?
- (A) It got him into trouble with his parents.
 - (B) He realised that this skill was unusual.
 - (C) It was a skill that was not particularly useful.
 - (D) He did not want the ambulance officer to be called again.
24. What happened to Adam at the swimming carnival?
- (A) He had first place taken away from him.
 - (B) The sports master praised his swimming technique.
 - (C) He used the wrong swimming style and lost the race.
 - (D) The school cheered when he swam the whole length underwater.
25. Choose the word that correctly completes the sentence.
- The words 'at least what they could see of it from the surface' are meant to be read in a _____ tone of voice.
- (A) cheerful
 - (B) frustrated
 - (C) humorous
 - (D) disappointed
26. The word 'impeccable' means
- (A) stylish.
 - (B) perfect.
 - (C) creative.
 - (D) beautiful.

The Seasons of Kakadu

The Gundjeihmi-speaking people are indigenous to the Kakadu region of the Northern Territory of Australia. In this text, a Gundjeihmi-speaking child describes the seasons.

In the Gundjeihmi-speaking people's land in Kakadu, there are six seasons in the year.

In **Gurrung** we love finding the shells of *dini dini*—cicadas. We put them on our nature table, which we change for every season. The late afternoon wind, *mabilil*, brings the smell of the sea across the land. There are whirly whirly winds, too, which we run and jump into.

In **Gunumeleng** we love watching *Namarrgon*, the lightning man, line up all the clouds in the sky, ready for a storm. This is when his children, *aldjurr*, change their colours. This is also the time when we find shiny red bush apples that lie on the ground, ready for us to eat.

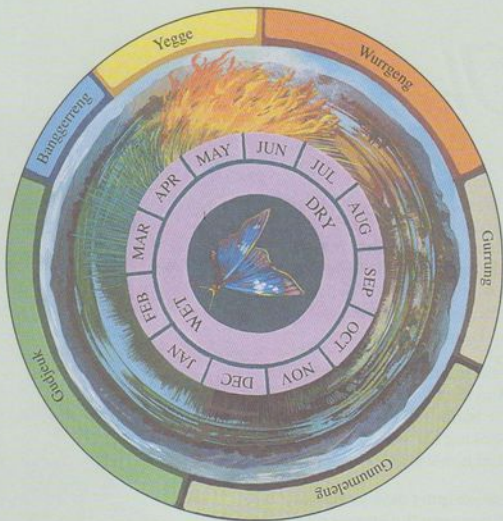
In **Gudjeuk** we love to make shelters out of sheets of paperbark. We eat the luscious red fruit of *anmamdak*, the canthium plum. When night falls, we like to watch the glow beetles dance in the darkness, or lie in our beds and listen to the drumming of the rain.

In **Banggerreng** we love to walk through the spear grass looking for the hiding yam vines so we can dig them up to cook. This is the time when the tall spear grass falls over from the knock 'em down storms. It is fun to make cubbyhouses with bundles of grass before the fires come and eat them up.

In **Yegge** we love to swim among the waterlilies in the lagoon and nibble on their seeds. This is the dry season, when the wind blows the fires across the land, cleaning away the old grass and fallen branches. As we walk through the bush, we chew on the fat billygoat plums.

In **Wurrng** we love to huddle around the campfire on the cold nights, under a sky full of bright stars. We listen to the wind blowing through the trees, and we hear *gordol*, the grass owls, calling. We make up our own songs about the bush and the seasons. Soon it will be **Gurrung** again!

27. According to the text, what season would you be in if you were listening to the rain inside your paperbark shelter?
- (A) Gunumeleng
(B) Gudjeuk
(C) Banggerreng
(D) Yegge
28. The writer has chosen words like 'the knock 'em down storms' and 'the fires come and eat them up' in order to
- (A) make fun of nature.
(B) give the land human qualities.
(C) show that the natural world is unusual.
(D) describe the power of nature in a technical way.



29. According to the text, the Gundjeihmi-speaking people eat two types of
- (A) yam.
(B) seed.
(C) plum.
(D) apple.
30. The words written in *italics* in the text are
- (A) scientific names.
(B) diagram captions.
(C) Gundjeihmi terms.
(D) English translations.
31. According to the diagram, the two longest seasons in Kakadu are
- (A) Gurrung and Wurrng.
(B) Gudjeuk and Wurrng.
(C) Gunumeleng and Gurrung.
(D) Gunumeleng and Gudjeuk.
32. What do the Gundjeihmi-speaking children do in April?
- (A) listen to the grass owls
(B) search for cicada shells
(C) make cubbyhouses with the long grass
(D) watch the lightning man line up the clouds

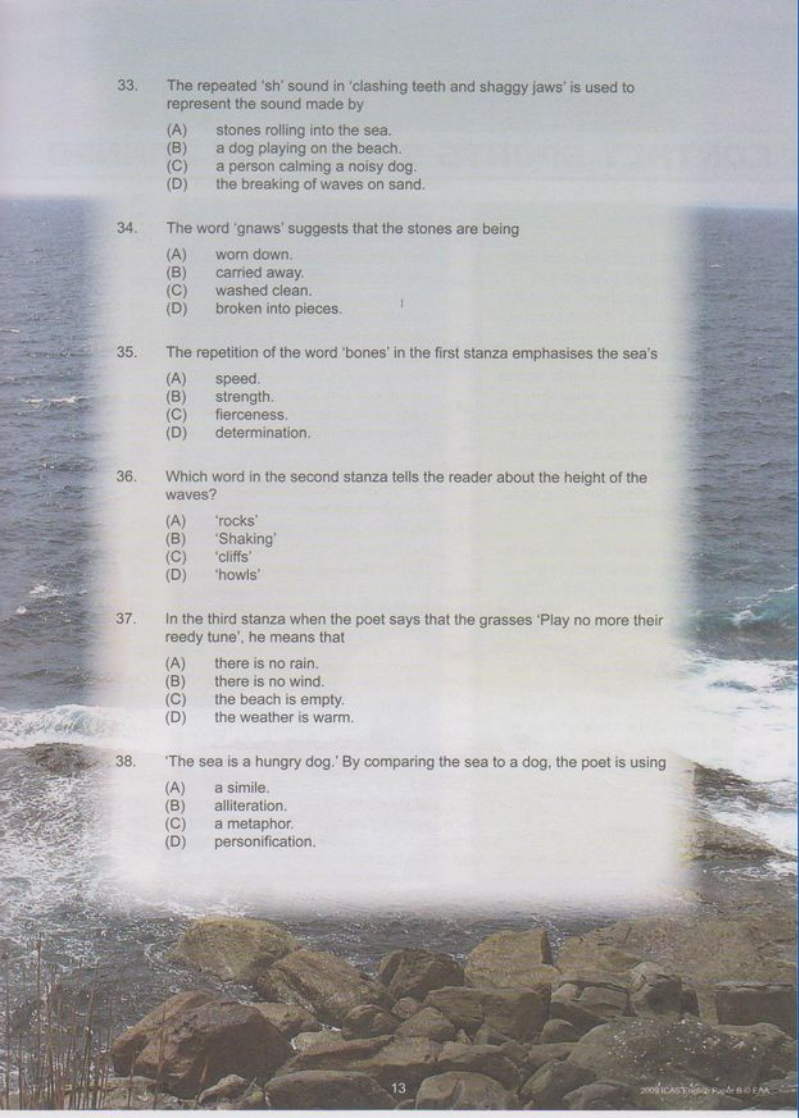
The Sea

The sea is a hungry dog,
Giant and grey.
He rolls on the beach all day.
With his clashing teeth and shaggy jaws
Hour upon hour he gnaws
The rumbling, tumbling stones,
And 'Bones, bones, bones, bones!'
The giant sea-dog moans,
Licking his greasy paws.

And when the night wind roars
And the moon rocks in the stormy cloud,
He bounds to his feet and snuffs and sniffs,
Shaking his wet sides over the cliffs,
And howls and hollos long and loud.

But on quiet days in May or June,
When even the grasses on the dune
Play no more their reedy tune,
With his head between his paws
He lies on the sandy shores,
So quiet, so quiet, he scarcely snores.

James Reeves

- 
33. The repeated 'sh' sound in 'clashing teeth and shaggy jaws' is used to represent the sound made by
- (A) stones rolling into the sea.
 - (B) a dog playing on the beach.
 - (C) a person calming a noisy dog.
 - (D) the breaking of waves on sand.
34. The word 'gnaws' suggests that the stones are being
- (A) worn down.
 - (B) carried away.
 - (C) washed clean.
 - (D) broken into pieces.
35. The repetition of the word 'bones' in the first stanza emphasises the sea's
- (A) speed.
 - (B) strength.
 - (C) fierceness.
 - (D) determination.
36. Which word in the second stanza tells the reader about the height of the waves?
- (A) 'rocks'
 - (B) 'Shaking'
 - (C) 'cliffs'
 - (D) 'howls'
37. In the third stanza when the poet says that the grasses 'Play no more their reedy tune', he means that
- (A) there is no rain.
 - (B) there is no wind.
 - (C) the beach is empty.
 - (D) the weather is warm.
38. 'The sea is a hungry dog.' By comparing the sea to a dog, the poet is using
- (A) a simile.
 - (B) alliteration.
 - (C) a metaphor.
 - (D) personification.

CONTACT SPORTS SHOULD BE BANNED

FOR

If you were catching a bus and people started pushing and shoving to get ahead, would this be acceptable? If such behaviour is banned on the streets, then why not on the sporting field? Many arrogant and spoilt 'sports heroes' think that when they are on the field, they are allowed to vent their spleen, sometimes by rupturing someone else's. What they need is not more money and more fame, but more anger management training.

The sad thing is that violence in sports not only affects players, but also the wider public. Clubs and their overpaid stars become rich because people can't seem to get enough of the general bad behaviour that happens on and off the field. Do we truly want impressionable young children to think that such behaviour is acceptable, or even entertaining?

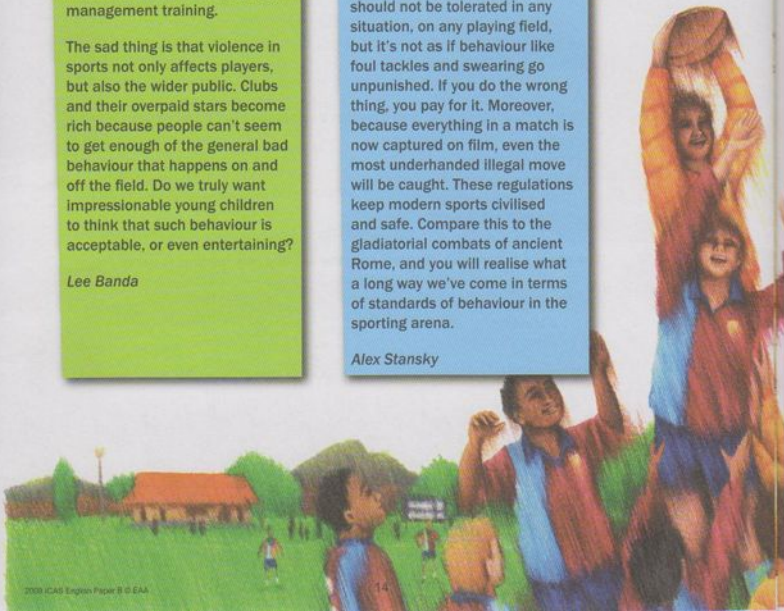
Lee Banda

AGAINST

Ban all contact sports? Nonsense! Rather than encouraging violence, contact sports enable people to be competitive, but in a regulated and controlled way. It is highly demanding: you must beat your opponent but only by relying on athletic skill and tactics, not violence or cheating. It's not just all brawn. You need brains as well.

Of course violent behaviour should not be tolerated in any situation, on any playing field, but it's not as if behaviour like foul tackles and swearing go unpunished. If you do the wrong thing, you pay for it. Moreover, because everything in a match is now captured on film, even the most underhanded illegal move will be caught. These regulations keep modern sports civilised and safe. Compare this to the gladiatorial combats of ancient Rome, and you will realise what a long way we've come in terms of standards of behaviour in the sporting arena.

Alex Stansky



39. What information does the title 'Contact sports should be banned' provide?
- (A) It introduces the topic for the arguments.
 - (B) It adds a third person's opinion on the topic.
 - (C) It gives the writers' opinions about the topic.
 - (D) It shows the result of the discussion on the topic.
40. Which of the following is **NOT** used by Lee Banda to engage the reader in the first sentence?
- (A) He asks for the reader's opinion.¹
 - (B) He addresses the reader directly.
 - (C) He describes a believable situation for the reader.
 - (D) He uses his own experience to prove his point of view.
41. Lee Banda believes that there is violence on the sporting field because
- (A) bad behaviour affects all teams.
 - (B) players are proud of their bad behaviour.
 - (C) bad behaviour is tolerated on the streets.
 - (D) fans enjoy seeing players' bad behaviour.
42. According to Alex Stansky, contact sports are won by
- (A) clubs employing highly paid star players.
 - (B) players obeying all the rules of the game.
 - (C) doing whatever needs to be done to defeat the opponent.
 - (D) players using a mixture of physical ability and intelligence.
43. Alex Stansky argues that there is now less bad behaviour in contact sports because
- (A) players are becoming more educated.
 - (B) there is so much competition in modern sport.
 - (C) there is a high chance of foul play being penalised.
 - (D) players want to act as role models for young people.
44. Modern sports are compared to gladiatorial combats in order to
- (A) show how sport has changed over time.
 - (B) confirm that sport has always had strict rules.
 - (C) prove that there is more violence in modern sports.
 - (D) highlight the similarities between the two types of sport.
45. Both writers believe that
- (A) players receive too much money.
 - (B) children should not play contact sports.
 - (C) violence should not be accepted in sport.
 - (D) players need training in anger management.



E

2009 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	A	B	D	B	A	A	A	C
2	A	B	A	D	C	C	C	A
3	B	A	A	C	B	D	B	D
4	C	A	A	B	B	B	A	B
5	A	B	C	C	D	A	D	B
6	A	C	B	A	D	D	D	A
7	C	B	D	B	A	C	A	B
8	C	B	D	A	D	B	C	D
9	C	D	C	A	D	D	A	A
10	B	D	B	A	A	C	A	B
11	D	D	A	B	A	B	C	D
12	D	A	A	C	C	C	C	C
13	D	C	C	C	B	A	A	D
14	B	A	B	D	A	B	B	D
15	C	D	D	D	A	D	D	D
16	D	A	D	A	B	D	D	A
17	A	C	C	C	D	C	B	A
18	B	B	B	D	A	B	B	C
19	C	B	C	C	A	A	B	A
20	A	D	A	D	B	B	D	B
21	D	A	B	B	C	A	C	C
22	B	D	A	C	B	C	B	C
23	C	B	A	B	A	C	D	B
24	B	A	B	D	D	C	B	D
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31	B	D	D	A	C	C	D	C
32	C	C	C	D	C	B	C	D
33	A	D	B	B	B	D	D	A
34	D	A	C	D	D	B	A	B
35	B	D	C	D	C	A	A	C
36	A	C	D	A	B	C	B	D
37	C	B	C	B	C	A	C	A
38	B	C	D	A	A	B	D	C
39	D	A	B	C	B	C	A	B
40	D	D	C	D	B	D	C	B

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E

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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
41	A	D	B	A	C	D	B	B
42	D	D	A	B	D	A	D	D
43	B	C	C	B	D	B	D	A
44	D	A	A	C	C	A	C	B
45	B	C	C	D	C	B	A	A
46			B	B	A	C	C	C
47			D	A	A	A	B	D
48			B	A	B	D	C	A
49			B	A	C	B	A	C
50			C	D	D	A	B	C
51					D	B	A	C
52					D	D	B	A
53					C	A	C	D
54					A	D	A	C
55					B	C	B	D
56							D	D
57							C	B
58							B	D
59							D	C
60							D	A

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